Joshua Fields

Senior Technical Gameplay & Systems Designer

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PROFILE

Senior technical gameplay and systems designer specialising in player-facing systems, hands-on Unreal implementation and production delivery. Turns ambiguous needs into clear, tunable systems carried through validation, hardening and documentation.

> **Selected case studies:** Physical response · Companion drone · Player guidance · Grenade Football

CORE CAPABILITIES

- **Gameplay systems and feature ownership:** combat, weapons, abilities, companion systems, physical response and multiplayer modes.
- **Unreal implementation:** Unreal Engine 5, Blueprint, Gameplay Ability System, UMG, data assets, tables and curves.
- **Player experience:** controls, guidance, HUD, augmented-reality markers, minimap, objectives and feedback.
- **Production delivery:** requirements, feasibility, tuning, validation, hardening, mentoring and durable documentation.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Build a Rocket Boy — Scotland (remote) **July 2022–Present**

Senior Game Designer May 2024–Present

Game Designer April 2023–May 2024

Associate Game Designer July 2022–April 2023

Selected systems and outcomes

- Redesigned physical response so configured impulse behaved predictably across differing masses, then separated damage and force into source-specific controls for safer tuning.
- Designed and balanced a Gameplay Ability System-based companion across controls, targeting, abilities, energy, cooldowns, regeneration, progression and feedback.
- Converted player feedback and level-specific drop-off signals into reusable persistent and scan-triggered guidance; production review recorded significantly lower churn after rollout.
- Delivered and iterated a physical multiplayer mode spanning football and launcher behaviour, player movement, possession and trajectory feedback, scoreboards and collision hardening.
- Led the mode-specific redesign of dash and jump, including stick-directed tackling, so movement supported the physical game loop rather than fighting it.
- Defined weapon identities through damage, rate of fire, recoil, spread, range, ammunition and inventory, then documented setup and cross-discipline dependencies.

DELIVERY AND LEADERSHIP

Build a Rocket Boy — continued

- Own gameplay and systems work from problem framing and behavioural definition through hands-on implementation, tuning, validation and documentation.
- Prototype and implement in Unreal Engine Blueprint, data and UI, exposing practical tuning controls while keeping system intent legible to other disciplines.
- Define requirements and acceptance expectations, investigate root causes and dependencies, and plan regression coverage across wider gameplay and multiplayer contexts.
- Coordinate delivery with engineering, AI, animation, UI, art, audio, VFX, narrative, production and QA from early definition through release support.
- Provide acting-lead support through design review, mentoring, engine guidance, task-priority input and risk assessment; create reusable setup, testing and debugging documentation.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Odeon Cinemas — Edinburgh, Scotland **December 2021–July 2022**

Cinema Experience Manager

- Designed learning modules and administered training and development for more than 40 staff and managers.
- Converted customer feedback into practical training and process improvements.

Royal Mail — Postal Worker · April–December 2021

Self-employed — ESL Teacher · August 2016–April 2021

Vodafone — Assistant Store Manager · June 2015–August 2016

Virgin Media — Senior Sales Executive · February 2011–June 2015

EDUCATION

BSc Computing & IT, The Open University
Final project focused on user experience in video games.

TOOLS AND LANGUAGES

Tools: Unreal Engine 5, Blueprint, Gameplay Ability System, UMG, data assets, tables and curves, Jira, Confluence, Perforce, Visual Studio, Miro, Figma and Adobe Creative Suite.

Languages: English (native), Spanish (conversational).